Alberta's variance paperwork keeps bouncing back

1,713

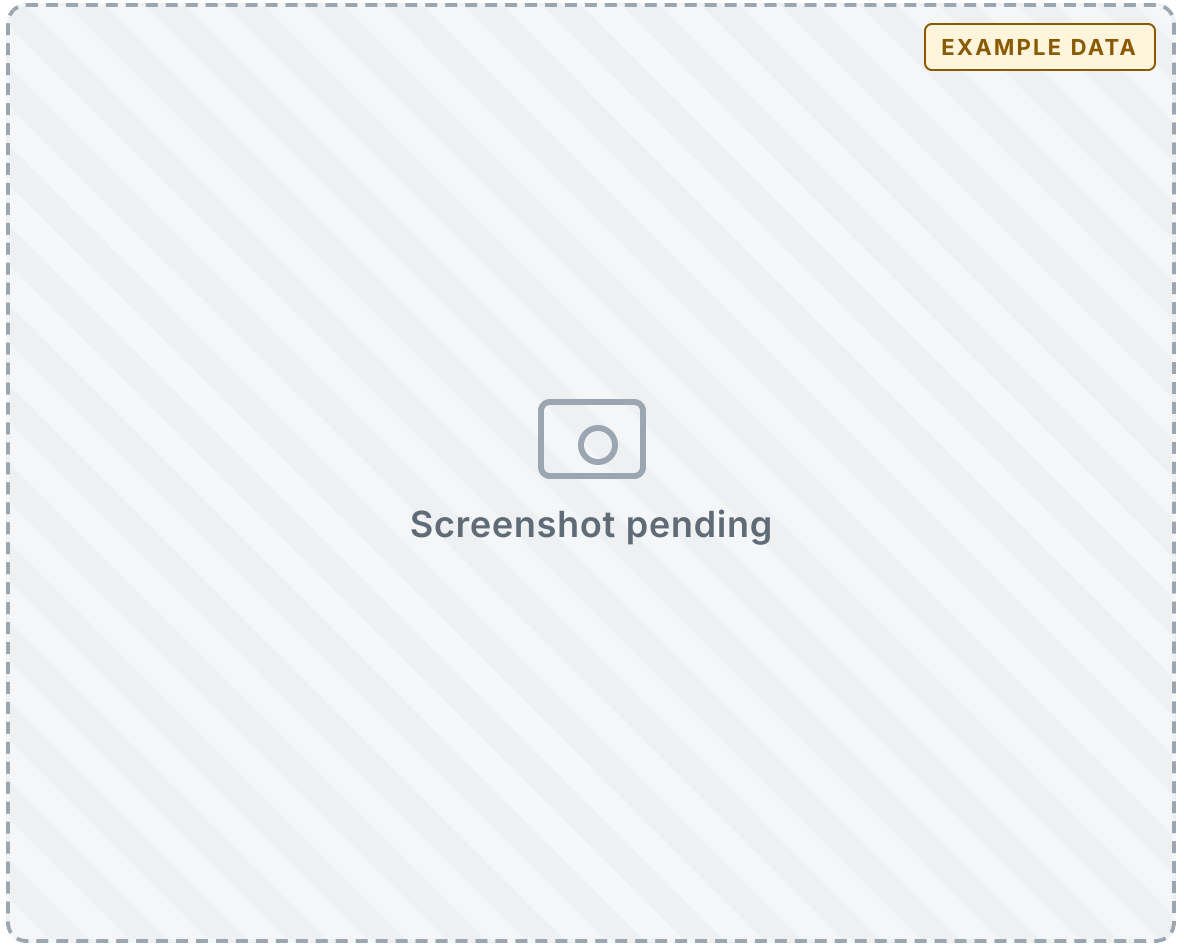
building variances registered in Alberta in 2022 · SCC Annual Report 2023

- Edmonton: about 67% of 2023 variances (all disciplines)
- No published service standard for variance review

Sources: SCC Annual Report 2023; challenge scope; full list in speaker notes

Describe your project in plain words [Intake, 20]

- Keeps your words; picks out a few facts
- The rest become questions (in review)



Describe screen lists gaps · in review

It asks before it guesses, and we test that [Intake, 20]

50/60

in-sample · model-checked

- 27 unknowns sent to the applicant
- Held-out: 7/8 blind, 4/8 after a fix

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

“Not sure” logged as questions · in review

Sources: in speaker notes

A ranked shortlist, measured against a named acceptable solution [Code Identification, 20]

0.312 m²

Example case · window opening vs 0.35 m² required

- Ranked against a named acceptable solution (draft, not in app)

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

Code search adds window article · in review

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

Identify output · draft, not in app

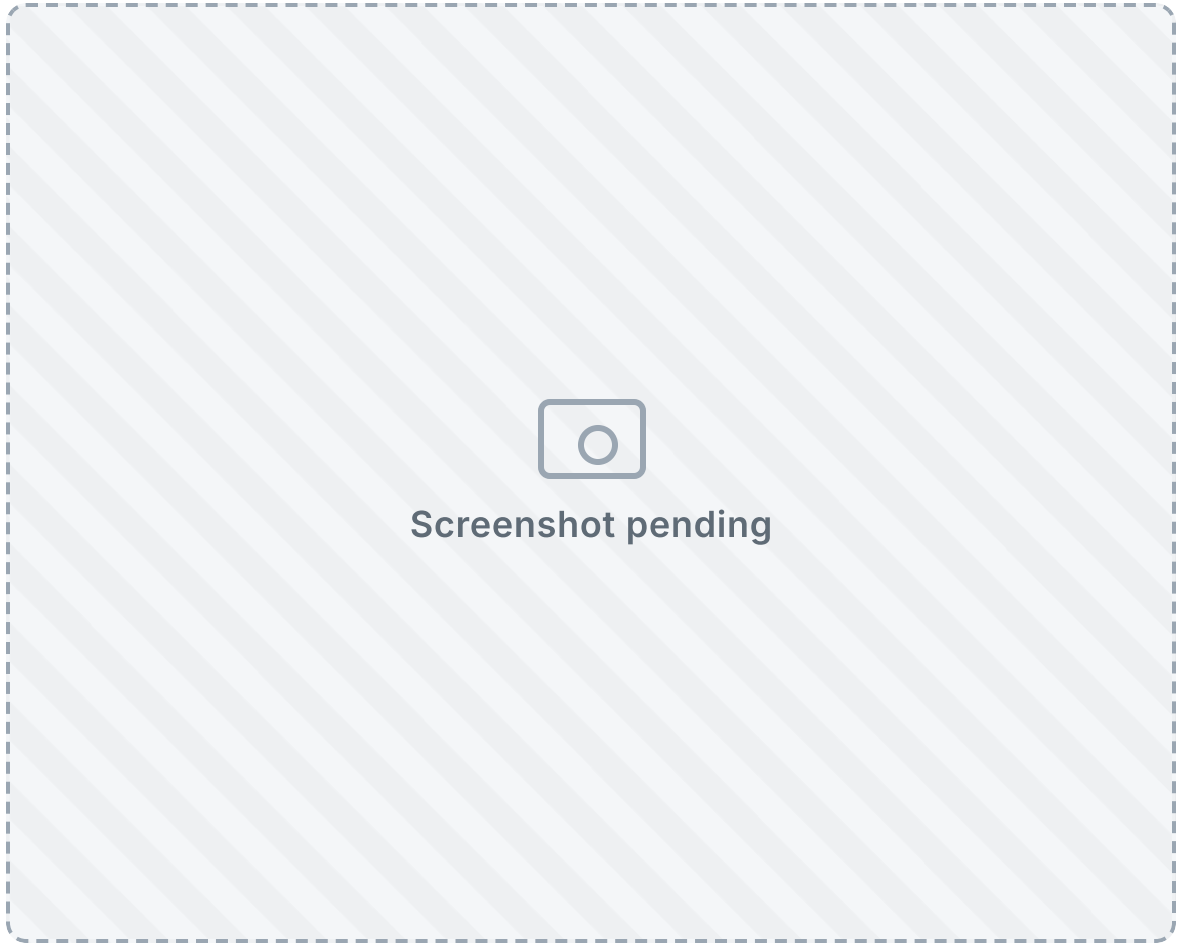
Sources: in speaker notes

Citations come from the code database [Code Identification, 20]

9/11

right article first · draft, not in the app

- NBC(AE) 2023, 2nd printing · model-checked, single run



Evaluation results per variant · model-checked

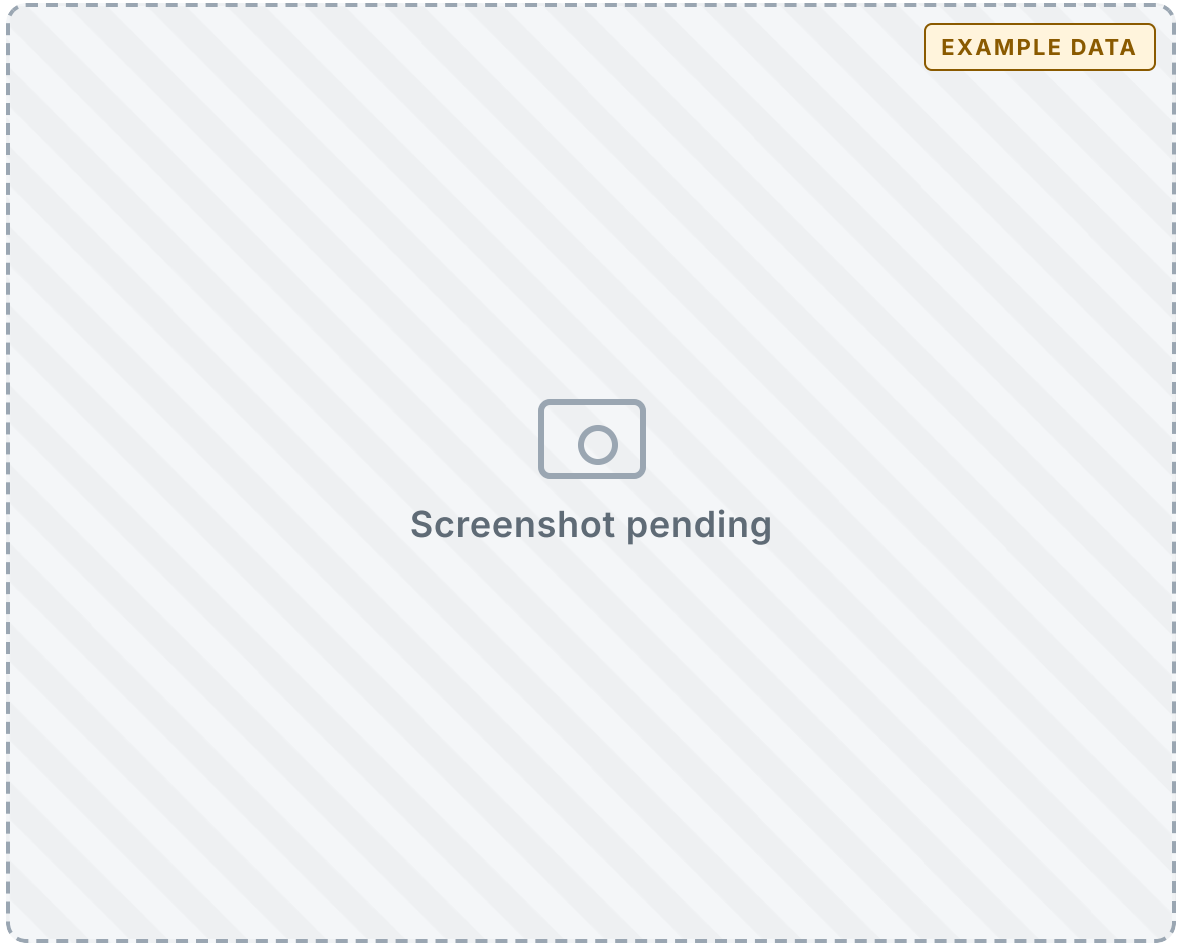
Sources: Alberta building codes; full list in speaker notes

It knows where to stop [Recommendations, 10]

50 Pa

Example case · firestop test pressure differential

- Designed to say an engineer's judgment is needed, and stop
- Never writes the evidence



Section D leaves evidence blank · in review

Sources: IFC engineering-judgment guidelines; full list in speaker notes

Completeness review: built in the engine, officer screen in review [Review, 10]

A–D

gaps listed by form section

- Completeness only, not a compliance finding
- Officer screen in review

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

Officer review, sample package · in review

Sources: IB-2025-11-18; IB-2026-10-01; full list in speaker notes

One tool, three kinds of first-time applicants [General Applicability, 5]

3

fictional first-time applicants, real code citations

- Homebuilder, manufacturer, general contractor
- Unaided use untested

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

“Who are you?” role picker · in review

Sources: STANDATA 23-BCV-017; STANDATA 23-BCV-001; STANDATA 23-BCV-003; Calgary B23-014; full list in speaker notes

Fills the current SCC form; built to travel [Usability and Portability, 10]

Oct 6, 2026

SCC form version

- Unsigned, officer Part 2 blank (in review)
- Not a compliance finding

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

Download locked while gaps open · in review

EXAMPLE DATA

Screenshot pending

Engine-filled SCC form · simulated session

Sources: SCC form; full list in speaker notes

Built for the December 1 rules [Implementation Plan, 10]

- From Dec 1, 2026: SCC portal only; registration is not approval
- Any pilot would be with an authority having jurisdiction (an organization)
- Oct 29 Submission 1 → Nov 26 build (our plan) → pilot Dec 2–Mar 2 (not guaranteed)

Sources: IB-2026-10-01; IB-2026-10-16; onboarding guide; full list in speaker notes

Applicants pay to arrive complete [Business Plan, 10]

- Production homebuilders pay C$125–750 per package (untested hypothesis)
- Identification: C$0.0277 per case, about 0.02% of the floor (draft, measured)
- Defensible as models improve: form tracking, citation validator, officer workflow

Sources: SCC fee schedule; Edmonton Procurement Standard; Calgary procurement policy; full list in speaker notes

We read the regulator's own data [X Factor, 5]

- Caught the Council's Oct 6, 2026 form change; export pinned to it
- 1,501 of 3,088 building article entries (Q1–Q2 2026): one soffit article
- Designed around three SCC bulletins from the past year

Sources: SCC Data Hub; full list in speaker notes